

# Caleb H. Kelley, Ph.D.

Visiting Assistant Professor  
Department of Spanish and Portuguese, Emory University

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## 🎓 EDUCATION

### Ph.D. in Romance Languages

2024

*The University of Alabama*

Tuscaloosa, AL

– **Dissertation:** *Sounding gay and straight in Seville: A variationist perspective on persona and syllable-final /s/ realization*

– **Advisor:** Dr. Erin O'Rourke

### M.A. in Romance Languages

2017

*The University of Alabama*

Tuscaloosa, AL

### B.A. in Spanish

2013

*University of Alabama at Birmingham*

Birmingham, AL

### B.S. in Biology

2013

*University of Alabama at Birmingham*

Birmingham, AL

## 🔍 RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research examines how speakers use phonetic variation to construct socially meaningful personae and how listeners interpret those cues, with particular attention to the vocal performance and perception of sexual identity in Spanish. I combine acoustic analysis, perception experiments, and computational modeling within a sociophonetic, third-wave variationist framework.

**Keywords:** sociophonetics; phonetics and phonology; language variation and change; language, gender, and sexuality; persona and indexicality; speech perception; Spanish and Hispanic linguistics; quantitative and computational methods

## 🏛️ ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

### Visiting Assistant Professor

2024 – present

*Department of Spanish and Portuguese, Emory University*

Atlanta, GA

### Graduate Teaching Assistant/Instructor of Record

2015 – 2024

*Department of Modern Languages and Classics, The University of Alabama*

Tuscaloosa, AL

### Adjunct Instructor of Spanish

2021 – 2022

*Department of English and World Languages, University of Montevallo*

Montevallo, AL

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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### At Emory University

#### Visiting Assistant Professor

2024 – present

Elementary and intermediate Spanish (SPAN 101, 102, 201, 202); SPAN 212: Introduction to Hispanic Texts and Contexts

- Design complete instructional units from learning objectives outward, producing lesson plans, instructor scripts, slide decks, handouts, and performance assessments aligned to ACTFL proficiency guidelines.
- Build and deliver Canvas course content and Integrated Performance Assessments across in-person, online, and blended sections.
- Authored a student-facing policy for responsible AI use built on a green, yellow, and red framework.
- Evaluate teaching through thematic analysis of course feedback and analysis of gradebook data in R, then turn the findings into course revisions.

### At The University of Alabama

#### Graduate Instructor of Record

2015 – 2024

Elementary and intermediate Spanish (SP 101, 102, 103, 201, 202), including online sections; SP 353: Spanish Conversation; SP 356: Advanced Grammar and Composition

- As Spanish 102 Coordinator, coordinated curriculum, quality standards, and assessment design across 43 sections of introductory Spanish, supporting and training a large team of graduate instructors.
- Mentored and team-taught with new instructors across three years, modeling student-centered classroom practice.
- Partnered with Dr. Bryan Koronkiewicz to design SP 383: Linguistic Fundamentals of the Spanish Language, turning specialist material into teachable lessons and assessments.

### At University of Montevallo

#### Adjunct Instructor

2021 – 2022

Elementary and intermediate Spanish (SPN 101, 102, 201)

## PUBLICATIONS

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### Manuscripts under Review

**Kelley, C. H.** (under review). Prosodic persona construction across three Spanish varieties: Asymmetric vocal stereotypes in Sevilla, País Vasco, and Venezuela.

### Manuscripts in Preparation

**Kelley, C. H.** (in preparation). Vowel space and performed identity in male Sevillian speech.

## CURRENT PROJECTS

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**Kelley, C. H.** (in progress). Sociophonetic perception of sexual identity: Evidence from native and non-native Spanish speakers. [Matched-guise perception study; data collection Fall 2026.]

**Kelley, C. H.** (in progress). Supervised classification of sociophonetic identity markers in Sevillian Spanish persona production. [Random Forest and SVM classification of a persona-switching corpus.]

### Invited Talks

- (2026, March 11). *From Production to Perception: Designing a Sociophonetic Study*, Department of Modern Languages and Classics, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.
- (2020, November). *Foundations of Spanish Phonetics and Phonology*, Guest Lecture for SP 383: Linguistic Fundamentals of the Spanish Language, University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

### Peer Reviewed Conference Presentations

- Kelley, C. H.** (2026). Modeling prosodic variation in Spanish gay and straight personae. *Southeastern Conference on Linguistics (SECOL) 2026*, Atlanta, GA. [accepted]
- Kelley, C. H.** (2024). Phonetic dimensions of gay-sounding speech in Spanish: Syllable-final /s/ variation and persona performance. *Linguistics Conference at the University of Georgia (LCUGA) 2024*, University of Georgia, Athens, GA.
- Kelley, C. H.** (2023). Analyzing the phonetic performance of male sexuality in Sevillian Spanish through remote data collection. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation (NWA) 51*, Queens College, Flushing, NY.
- Kelley, C. H.** (2023). Analyzing the performance of male sexuality in Spanish through remote data collection and digital corpus analysis. *Congreso Internacional de Lingüística Digital (CILiDi) 2*, Universidad de Alicante, Alicante, Spain.
- Kelley, C. H.** (2023). Syllable-final /s/ and the sociolinguistic construction of personae in Spanish speakers. *OSU Congress on Hispanic and Lusophone Linguistics Symposium (OSUCHILL) 27*, The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH.
- Kelley, C. H.** (2023). Using sociolinguistic personae to analyze phonetic variation among gay and non-gay Spanish speakers. *University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)*, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.
- Kelley, C. H.** (2022). A pilot study investigating sociophonetic variation among LGBTQ+ speakers in Peninsular Spanish. *University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)*, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.
- Kelley, C. H.** (2021). Sounding queer in Spain: A sociophonetic analysis of production and perception. *Lavender Languages & Linguistics 27*, California Institute of Integral Studies, San Francisco, CA [accepted 2020; conference postponed to 2021 due to COVID-19 pandemic].
- Jacobson, S., & **Kelley, C. H.** (2020). Very? Much!: A corpus analysis of alternation between “muy” and “mucho” in Spanish. *10th International Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics*, Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA [accepted; canceled due to COVID-19 pandemic].
- Jacobson, S., & **Kelley, C. H.** (2017). “To be” or “to not be”: Attitudes and behaviors toward the split infinitive in English. *8th International Contrastive Linguistics Conference*, National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Athens, Greece.
- Kelley, C. H.** (2016). The Madre María de San José (1656–1719) Project. *Digitarium: University of Alabama Digital Humanities Conference*, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.
- Kelley, C. H.** (2016). Null and overt subject pronouns in Madrid and Caracas with verbs of external activity: A corpus study. *Linguistics Conference at the University of Georgia (LCUGA) 3*, University of Georgia, Athens, GA.

## Peer Reviewed Poster Presentations

- Kelley, C. H.** (2025). Prosodic identity performance in Spanish: A mixed-effects analysis of gay and straight vocal personae. *Hispanic Linguistics Symposium (HLS) 2025*, University of Arizona, Tucson, AZ [accepted].
- Kelley, C. H.** (2022). Performing sexual orientation in Spanish: A pilot study investigating persona and syllable-final /s/ realization. *10th Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics (WSS10)*, University of Georgia, Athens, GA.
- Kelley, C. H.** (2016). Null and overt subject pronouns in Madrid and Caracas with verbs of external activity: A corpus study. *Quantitative Methods in Linguistics Research Showcase*, The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL.

## FUNDING

### Research Support

**Research support awards (4)** 2021 – 2024  
UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics

### Conference Travel

**Conference funding and travel awards (6)** 2017 – 2023  
UA Graduate School/Modern Languages and Classics; UA Capstone International

### External Applications

**Lewis and Clark Fund for Exploration and Field Research** 2022, 2023  
American Philosophical Society (not funded)

## SERVICE

### To the Profession

**Linguistic Society of America Committee on LGBTQ+ [Z] Issues in Linguistics (COZIL)** 2023 – 2024  
Member

**Abstract Reviewer** 2017 – 2022  
University of Alabama Languages Conference (UALC)

### To the Department and University

**Spanish 102 Coordinator** 2020 – 2022  
Spanish Basic Language Program, Department of Modern Languages and Classics, UA (43 sections)

**Graduate Student Representative** 2021 – 2022  
Department of Modern Languages and Classics, UA

**LengUA Lab Graduate Student Co-director** 2020 – 2021  
UA (Linguistics research group)

**LengUA Lab Member** 2016 – 2024  
UA

## Conference Organization

### Committee Member, UALC

University of Alabama Languages Conference

2021 – 2022

### IT Committee Member, UALC

University of Alabama Languages Conference

2020 – 2021

### Registration Chair, UALC

University of Alabama Languages Conference

2018 – 2019

### Vice President/Program Chair, UALC

University of Alabama Languages Conference

2017 – 2018

## Student Organizations and Community Outreach

### Vice President, La Última Letra

UA

2018 – 2019

### Secretary, La Última Letra

UA

2016 – 2017

### Event Judge, Convención de la Federación de los Círculos de Español de Alabama

2015 – 2020

## Mentoring

### Jim Moore

Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 102 course, UA

Spring 2021

### Katie Cauley

Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 102 course, UA

Fall 2020

### Jordyn Battistelli

Team teaching assistant and mentee for SP 201 course, UA

Fall 2019

## PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

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**Dissertation Summer Writing Challenge**, The University of Alabama. Summer 2022.

**David Bauer Grant Writing Workshop**, The University of Alabama. Fall 2021.

**Writing for Academic Publication**, Advanced Seminar (CSE 690), The University of Alabama. Spring 2019.

**Online Teaching Certification**, The University of Alabama. 2016 – 2024.

## MEMBERSHIPS, LANGUAGES, & TECHNICAL SKILLS

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| <b>Memberships</b> | Linguistics Society of America (LSA) • Acoustical Society of America (ASA) • Alabama World Languages Association (AWLA) • Sigma Delta Pi (Omicron Mu Chapter) |
| <b>Languages</b>   | English (native) • Spanish (near-native) • French (intermediate)                                                                                              |
| <b>Programming</b> | R • Python • Praat scripting • Bash/Unix • $\LaTeX$ • HTML/CSS • Git/GitHub                                                                                   |
| <b>Software</b>    | Microsoft Office 365 • Adobe Creative Suite • Qualtrics • RStudio • SPSS • Audacity • Montreal Forced Aligner • ELAN • Zotero • EndNote                       |
| <b>Platforms</b>   | Canvas • Blackboard • LingroLearning • VHL Central • Google Drive • Box                                                                                       |

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References available upon request.